

Red tape hampers marijuana pardons

Thousands of Mass. records still not updated

By Matt Stout
GLOBE STAFF

When Governor Maura Healey unveiled a blanket pardon of marijuana possession convictions in March 2024, her office said it would begin automatically updating people’s records to reflect the “most sweeping” move of its kind in the country. Better yet, state officials said, people would “probably not” have to do anything to claim a pardon, which could cover hundreds of thousands of people.

A year later, only a fraction of that number have proof they’ve been pardoned, as Healey’s promise of automatic relief, albeit well-intentioned, has collided with bureaucratic reality.

As of mid-March, state officials said they’ve corrected the records of fewer than 1,900 people to reflect that their conviction has been pardoned. It’s the product of what state officials described as a labor-intensive process. But, attorneys say, it also means the relief the blanket pardon was meant to deliver has been slow to materialize for many.

Aides to Healey said they’re working through a list of tens of thousands of people court officials have identified, who “would be most impacted by the marijuana pardon,” such as people with more recent convictions.

Healey’s office emphasized that even if an individual’s record has not been corrected, every person who had a misde-

PARDONS, Page A12



At least six people were killed in Tennessee, Missouri, and Indiana by storms that spawned powerful tornadoes, including many in Arkansas (above). **A2.**

Rats are getting bigger and more brazen in a British city where a sanitation strike has left tons of garbage piled up on the streets. **A3.**

The Red Sox return to Fenway today for the opener, after knocking off the Orioles again following a rough start to the season on the road. **C1.**



Grand opening

Friday: Much warmer. High 62-67. Low 38-43.

Saturday: Rain, cooler. High 41-46. Low 36-41.

High tide: 4:26 a.m., 5:16 p.m.

Sunrise: 6:21 Sunset: 7:13

Weather and Comics, G7. Obituaries, C11.

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



Tariffs shake the world

The S&P 500 Index lost 4.84 percent Thursday, its worst one-day loss since 2020

SOURCE: Bloomberg

MARCH 28 CLOSE
5,580.94

MARCH 31
5,611.85

APRIL 1
5,633.07

APRIL 2
5,670.97

APRIL 3
5,396.52

Markets melt down over Trump’s plan; US consumers brace

By Ana Swanson,
Daisuke Wakabayashi,
and River Akira Davis
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The scale of President Trump’s global tariffs began to sink in Thursday as stock markets fell sharply, countries warned of retaliation, and US companies and consumers braced for the impact on their bottom lines

and bank accounts.

The S&P 500 tumbled nearly 5 percent, a huge daily drop for the index that echoed sharp declines in Asia and Europe as investors balked at the tariffs. Trump had said for weeks that he would impose “reciprocal tariffs” on allies and adversaries, but the tariffs announced Wednesday, which will begin to take effect Saturday, were far higher than experts had expected.

China, one of the countries hardest hit by the tariffs, vowed to take countermeasures to “safeguard its own rights and interests.” Its state media described the tariffs as “self-defeating bullying.”

South Korea convened an emergency task force and vowed to “pour all government resources to overcome a trade crisis.” In Brussels, Ursula von der Leyen, the European Commission president, said, “If you take on one of us, you take on all of us.” French President Emmanuel Macron called on European companies to suspend all investments in the United States “until things have been clarified” over the tariffs.

WORLD REACTION, Page A6

‘The markets are going to boom, the stock is going to boom, and the country is going to boom.’

PRESIDENT TRUMP, Thursday afternoon

Behind Trump’s rosy vision of a windfall, a goal of funding tax-cut extension

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — President Trump boasts his massive tariffs will bring manufacturing back to the United States and rebalance an unfair global trading system. But for Republicans, they have another purpose: generating billions of dollars in government revenue to provide fiscal cover for the extension of his 2017 tax cuts.

“We have six or seven trillion dollars coming into our country,” Trump said to reporters Thursday, echoing a recent estimate from a top administration official of how much money the tariffs would produce over the next 10 years.

Extending the tax cuts, which expire on Dec. 31, will cost approximately \$4.5 trillion over the next decade. That total could go even higher if Congress adds provisions, such as Trump’s campaign promises to eliminate taxes on tips, overtime pay, and Social Security benefits. So Trump and his Republican allies in Congress need to find a pool of incoming funds to offset that price tag and avoid exploding the al-

TARIFFS, Page A6

Local stocks

Wayfair
-25.6%

Hasbro
-12.4%

Wolverine World Wide
-23.8%

Caught off guard by scope of changes, N.E. retailers fear they’ll have to raise prices

By Aaron Pressman
GLOBE STAFF

A day after President Trump’s tariff announcement, a hard reality set in for businesses in New England that depend on imports and a global supply chain, from furniture seller Wayfair to appliance maker SharkNinja and footwear brand Wolverine.

Trump’s announcement of an array of higher tariffs on dozens of countries triggered a convulsion in stock markets around the world. In the United States, the broad-based S&P 500 Index lost almost 5 percent of its value on Thursday, its worst one-day loss since 2020, and stocks of many local retail companies fared even worse.

Investors have long feared higher tariffs could spike inflation, slow growth, and frighten consumers, but the sheer size and breadth of what Trump did was much greater than anticipated. While companies were expecting stiff tariffs on China, many have spent years diversifying supply chains into Vietnam, India, and other even-lower cost countries. Then those countries, too, were hit with tariffs, as high as 46 percent.

RETAILERS, Page A7

DETAINEE’S CASE

Lawyers representing Rümeyşa Öztürk sparred with federal authorities over whether a judge in Boston has jurisdiction to decide what happens next. **B1.**



FACING A REVIEW

The Pentagon’s acting inspector general will review Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth’s use of the Signal messaging app to convey plans for a military strike in Yemen. **A5.**

Trump administration demands Harvard end DEI, toughen student discipline

By Mike Damiano
GLOBE STAFF

The Trump administration’s antisemitism task force sent Harvard University a list of demands Thursday detailing actions the school must take to avoid losing billions of dollars in federal funding, according to a copy of the letter obtained by the Globe and a federal government official familiar with the matter.

The demands follow the announcement Monday that the Trump adminis-

tration will “review” \$9 billion of federal grants and contracts destined for the university and its affiliated institutions, including preeminent research hospitals like Mass General Brigham and Boston Children’s Hospital.

The demands include closing diversity, equity, and inclusion programs, which the letter says teach students and

staff “to make snap judgments about each other based on crude race and identity stereotypes.”

Moreover, the university must implement “merit-based” admissions and hiring policies and demonstrate that the changes are “durable,” according to the letter.

It asks Harvard to create new “[o]versight and accountability for biased programs that fuel antisemitism” and de-

HARVARD, Page A8